

Introductions

How you begin your presentation depends on how formal the situation is. Most audiences prefer a relatively informal approach.

TASK 1

Below you will find two alternative ways of introducing yourself and the subject of your presentation – one fairly formal, the other more friendly. At each stage choose the expression you would feel more comfortable using and highlight it.

FAIRLY FORMAL

Erm, perhaps we should begin.

Good morning, ladies and gentlemen.

On behalf of . . . , may I welcome you to . . .

My name's . . .

For those of you who don't know me already,

I'm responsible for . . .

This morning I'd like to . . .

discuss . . .

report on . . .

and present . . .

If you have any questions you'd like to ask,
I'll be happy to answer them.

or

Perhaps we can leave any questions you
may have until the end of the presentation.

How happy would you be taking questions a) during your presentation b) at the end?

MORE FRIENDLY

OK, let's get started.

Morning, everyone.

Thanks for coming.

I'm . . .

As you know, . . .

I'm in charge of . . .

What I want to do this morning is . . .

talk to you about . . .

tell you about . . .

and show you . . .

Feel free to ask any questions you like
as we go along.

And don't worry, there'll be plenty of
time left over for questions at the end.

TASK 2

Now put together an introduction of your own using some of the expressions you chose above. Remember how important it is to be totally confident about this part of your presentation.

Don't waste a lot of time at the beginning of your presentation introducing yourself, your company and the subject of your talk. Get on with it!

PRESENTATION

Prepare to introduce and state the purpose of a presentation of your own by completing the notes below. Then present your introduction.

Perhaps we should begin. or OK, let's get started.
Good morning / afternoon / evening, everyone.

Thanks for coming. I'm And, as you know, I
.....
.....
.....

This morning I'm going to be

- talking to you about
- telling you
- showing you
- reporting on
- taking a look at

.....
.....

So, I'll start off by

- filling you in on the background to
- bringing you up-to-date on
- giving you an overview of
- making a few observations about
- outlining

.....
.....

And then I'll go on to

- highlight what I see as the main
- put the situation into some kind of perspective
- discuss in more depth the implications of
- talk you through
- make detailed recommendations regarding

.....
.....

Stating Your Purpose 1

It is essential to state the purpose of your presentation near the beginning. To do this clearly and effectively you need a few simple presentation verbs: **take a look at, report on, give an overview of etc.**

cass

TASK

Below you will find a number of ways of stating the purpose of your presentation. Complete them using the words given. Combining the sentences with the number 1 will give you a complete introduction. Then do the same with those numbered 2 etc. The cassette provides a good model for you. Use it to check your answers after you have done the exercise.

OK, let's get started. Good morning, everyone. Thanks for coming. I'm (your name).
This morning I'm going to be:

showing talking taking reporting telling

1. talking ... to you about the videophone project.
- ✓ 2. telling ... you about the collapse of the housing market in the early 90s.
3. showing ... you how to deal with late payers.
4. taking ... a look at the recent boom in virtual reality software companies.
5. reporting ... on the results of the market study we carried out in Austria.

... so, I'll begin by / start off by

making outlining bringing giving filling

1. filling ... you in on the background to the project.
2. making ... a few observations about the events leading up to that collapse.
3. outlining ... company policy on bad debt.
- ✓ 4. giving ... you an overview of the history of VR.
5. bringing ... you up-to-date on the latest findings of the study.

... and then I'll go on to:

put discuss make highlight talk

1. highlight ... what I see as the main advantages of the new system.
2. put ... the situation into some kind of perspective.
3. talk ... you through our basic debt management procedure.
4. make ... detailed recommendations regarding our own R&D.
5. discuss ... in more depth the implications of the data in the files in front of you.

Highlight all the verb phrases above, eg. *talking to you about, making a few observations about*. Notice it is not the verb alone, but the whole phrase you need to learn.

Signposting

In a good presentation, what you say – the content – is much more important than anything else. But a clear structure helps. When you move on to your next point or change direction, tell the audience.

You can do this easily and effectively, using simple phrases as 'signposts' to guide the audience through your presentation:

To move on
To expand on
To digress

To go back
To recap
To conclude

To summarize
To turn to
To elaborate on

TASK 1

Choose one of the 'signpost' expressions from the box above for the following situations:

1. When you want to make your next point.
2. When you want to change direction.
3. When you want to refer to an earlier point.
4. When you want to repeat the main points.
5. When you want to give a wider perspective.
6. When you want to do a deeper analysis.
7. When you just want to give the basics.
8. When you want to depart from your plan.
9. When you want to finish your talk.

To move on (to your next point)
To turn to (last year's figures)
To go back (to what I said earlier)
To recap (on the main features of ...)
To expand on (this a bit more)
To elaborate on (this particular feature)
To summarize (the salient point)
To digress (just for a moment)
To conclude

CASS TASK 2

These nine basic signposts are all you need, but you have to remember them automatically. Listen to your cassette or your teacher. When you hear an instruction, for example, *make your next point*, write the correct phrase:

1.
2.
3.
4.
5.
6.
7.
8.
9.

Survival Tactics

Giving a presentation in a foreign language is a challenge. Concentrate too hard on the facts and you make language mistakes. Concentrate too hard on your English and you get your facts wrong.

TASK 1

If you have problems during your presentation, don't panic. Pause. Sort out the problem and continue. Here are the eight most common problems people face. Match what you think with what you say:

WHAT YOU THINK

- c 1. I've got my facts wrong!
- a 2. Too fast! Go back.
- d 3. I've forgotten to say something!
- b 4. Too complicated! Make it simple.
- h 5. I'm talking nonsense.
- g 6. How do you say this in English?
- f 7. Wrong! Try again.
- e 8. I'm running out of time!

WHAT YOU SAY 摘要重述

- a. So, let's just recap on that.
- b. So, basically, what I'm saying is this . . .
- c. Sorry, what I meant is this . . .
- d. Sorry, I should just mention one thing.
- e. So, just to give you the main points here . . .
- f. Sorry, let me rephrase that.
- g. Sorry, what's the word / expression?
- h. Sorry, perhaps I didn't make that quite clear.

Notice how some of the words are stressed in each phrase. Repeat the phrases until you feel comfortable saying them.

cass TASK 2

Knowing how to get out of difficulty in a presentation is essential. If you learn these expressions by heart, you will be able to do it automatically and, therefore, confidently. Listen to the following problems and use the correct survival phrase.

- | | |
|----------------------------|--|
| 1. Facts wrong! | > Sorry, what I . meant is . . this. |
| 2. Too fast! | > So, let's just recap on . that. |
| 3. Forgotten something! | > Sorry, I . should just mention one . thing. |
| 4. Too complicated! | > So, basically, what I'm saying is . this. |
| 5. Talking nonsense! | > Sorry, perhaps I . didn't make it quite clear. |
| 6. Don't know the English! | > Sorry, what's word I'm looking for? |
| 7. Sounds wrong! | > Sorry, let me . rephrase that . |
| 8. No time! | > So, just to . give you the main points here. |

Repeat this activity several times until you can do it automatically.